Institute of Social Sciences and the National Centre for the Performing Arts in Mumbai.

Business with a conscience

While Tata was acquainted with several Congress leaders, and sympathetic to the freedom movement, he did not actively participate in politics. However, he was keen to contribute to India's growth and economic development in a significant way. In 1944, Tata and several other leading businessmen like GD Birla, Purushotamdas Thakurdas and Kasturbhai Lalbhai, formulated the Bombay Plan for developing the Indian economy. This revolutionary plan envisioned the government and industrialists working together to invest in and grow India's heavy industry—power, mining, railways, roads and iron and steel. The plan also dedicated large sums of money towards educational and social reform programmes. Although it was never implemented, it remains an interesting example of how early Indian business leaders viewed their role in nation-building.

